

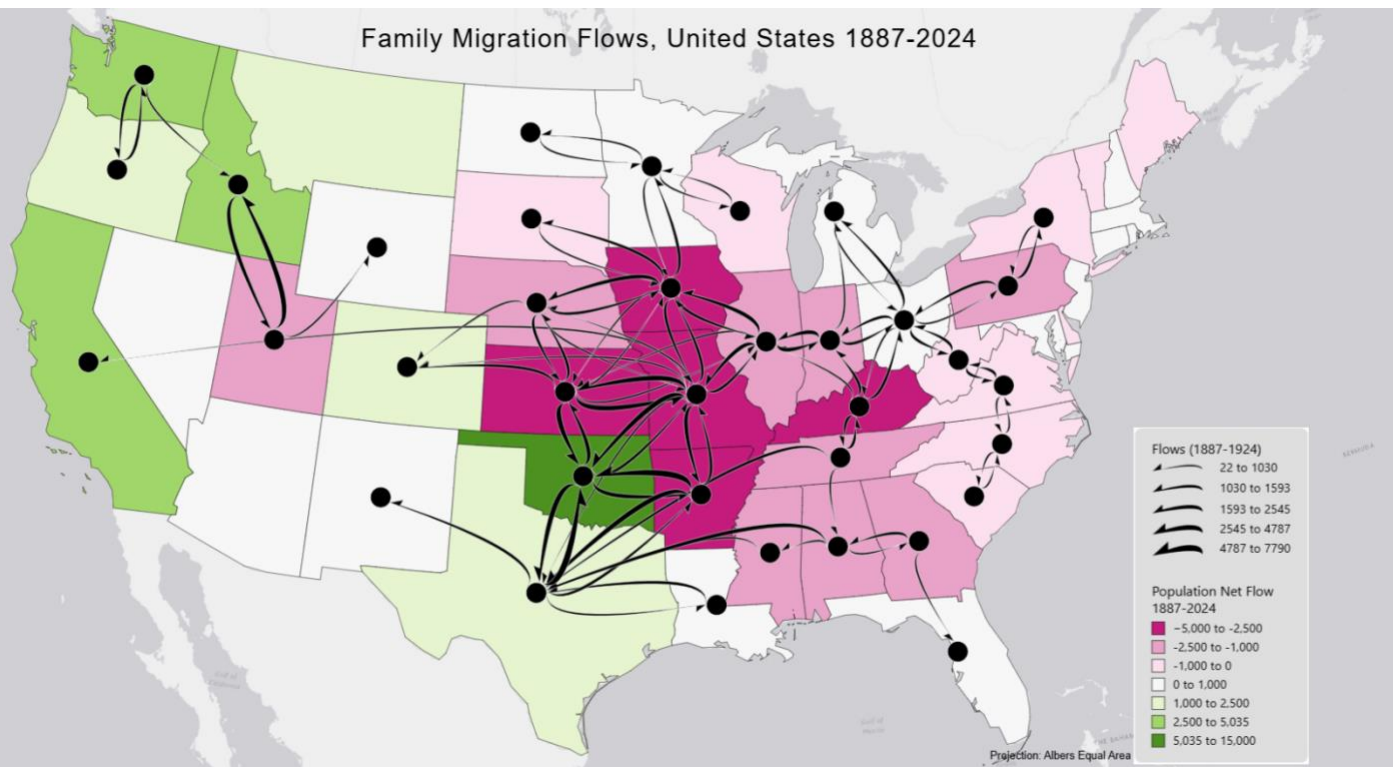
SEES: 3540 Assignment 6

Flow Mapping

Jack Pieters

Dr. Caglar Koylu

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Discussion Question Responses

1. I chose to use a diverging color scheme from pink to green, as I wanted to display the inward and outward flows based around a breaking point. I created the classes displayed above manually, and I made the central class (the point of divergence) relatively small related to the other ones. It still does display a positive net flow, but I figured up to 1000 families was a fair value to be in the middle. The choropleth has seven classes total. I chose the nodes and the arrows to be black as the simplicity of the color didn't clash with the selected color scheme of the choropleth, and it maintains visibility. I reduced the "Show top flows", or the number of flows to be displayed, to 85. This ensured the overlap between flows on the map were minimal- if there were many more displayed, the map started to appear to be quite overwhelming.
2. The states that receive the most flows in the map above are Oklahoma, California, Idaho, and Washington. Oklahoma has the highest population net flow of all the states at just above 12,000 total net flow. California, Washington, and Idaho fall within the 2500 to 5035 range. The states we saw with the highest *negative* net flow, or sending the most flow, in this time-period were Iowa, Kansas, Missouri, Arkansas, and Kentucky. These four states had outward flows ranging from 2500

to 5000 families outbound. This map is displaying the very end of America's great westward expansion, where many families that were settled east of the Mississippi decided to move to the frontier for more space and new work. The arrowheads on top of the choropleth map do a great job together in creating a visualization by showing the movement from region to region. The arrows provide more nuance than a choropleth alone, as we can see a relationship between each state's flow value. For example, without the flow arrows being added, Missouri would stand out for having a very significant negative net flow. With the addition of the arrows, we can see this might have been one of the more trafficked states in the time frame, as it has some of the largest arrows outwards towards Oklahoma, Kansas, and Arkansas. There even appears to be plenty of families migrating out of Kansas into Missouri- just not enough to offset the number leaving the state.